



Healthy Community Lifespaces

Pennsylvania School Student contest

Creating a State Symbol – 2025/26 State Vegetable Contest

Educators, Parents and Students

This contest incorporates health and the importance of eating more fruits and vegetables into lessons in science and/or social studies to align with state standards for studying the legislative process, state symbols, or origins of plants to determine a native state fruit and vegetable. Creative displays to go with a written proposal are welcome. Multiple methods of presentations to meet various learning styles are welcome. Small groups or individual entries are welcome.

As a nation, state, community, and individuals, health and well-being are a needed priority. Multiple private and public agencies are looking to solve the health disparities and promote health for all. Various advisory committees from all sectors of the community have formed a framework to improve health for all people. On a national level, the US government plan Healthy People 2030, states that "promoting and achieving health and well-being nationwide is a shared responsibility that is distributed across the national, state, tribal, and community levels, including the public, private, and not-for-profit sectors". Many states, including Pennsylvania, have a State Health Improvement Plan. (SHIP). HCL is on the task force working on the new plan to set priorities, direct resource use, and develop projects, programs, and policies. Research conveys a supportive community incorporating health into all environments, policies, agencies, and curriculum is needed to achieve health. Thank you for joining in developing a healthy community.

For more information on PA SHIP (cover by PA high school student)

chrome-extension://efaidnbmnnnibpcajpcglclefindmkaj/https://www.pa.gov/content/dam/copapwp-pagov/en/health/documents/topics/documents/ship/SHIP_2023-2028.pdf



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First prizes are several \$25 dollar scholarships towards the student winners to participate in a physical fitness activity of their choice.

Honorable mention - Bike helmet

HCL will facilitate the winners to talk with PA State legislators to pass the legislation for their chosen vegetable . A fruit is currently being considered for the State find out more here



Official Rules

- Students in Grades 4- 7 can enter with parent and teacher permission.
- Contest students must submit a proposal for a vegetable to be a State symbol.
- The proposal should include:
 - Vegetables with most the health benefits.
 - Most native to Pennsylvania or that all Pennsylvanians will have access find to eat.
 - Reasons why Pennsylvanians should eat this vegetable(s).
 - Reasons why we should have vegetables as state symbol.

Basic contest Rubric

Feature	4	3	2	1	Score
Ideas	Strong Informative with clear focus and supporting reason for choice of fruit or vegetable	Developing Develops a focus Uses some descriptive language Details support idea Communicates original ideas	Emerging Attempts focus Ideas not fully developed	Beginning Lacks focus and development	
Organization	Establishes a strong beginning, middle, and end Demonstrates an orderly flow of ideas	Attempts an adequate introduction and ending Evidence of logical sequencing	Some evidence of a beginning, middle, and end Sequencing is attempted	Little or no organization Relies on single idea	



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Expression	Uses effective language Uses high-level vocabulary Use of sentence variety	Diverse word choice Uses descriptive words Sentence variety	Limited word choice Basic sentence structure/speech	No sense of sentence structure/ in speech if presented as video
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- Email entry to Healthy Community Lifespaces at

Healthycommunitylifespaces@gmail.com

- Contest entries should be received by December 31, 2026

Student Name:

Email to send contest results:

Teacher

School

Grade

Parent permission:

I give permission for my student's name to be announced if your child wins, I agree to use the prize monies towards participation in a physical activity in my community and I take responsibility for any and all liability pertaining to -transportation to and from the activity should my child win the contest.

Parent signature

- Contact HCL with any questions or for lesson plan ideas or to pick up multiple class projects in other media if unable to email.

In Collaboration to make Pennsylvania a healthy environment for all children,

Dr. Marianne Infante, M.Ed., OTD
HCL Healthy Community Lifespaces
healthycommunitylifespaces@gmail.com
 610-505-0515

Have a 😊 healthy day!

Get involved in making your local student wellness policy in line with the PA state model wellness plan [PSBA Local School Wellness Policy Template](#) found at:

<https://www.education.pa.gov/Teachers%20-%20Administrators/Food-Nutrition/Resources/Pages/Local-Wellness.aspx>

PA School Student Contest Winners 2024/25 State Fruit